

National Audit of Pulmonary Hypertension

Local Action Plan - 10th Annual Report

Pg	Standard	Recommendation	Planned action
23	95 per cent of patients receiving a pulmonary hypertension drug therapy (excluding patients diagnosed as pulmonary arterial hypertension associated with congenital heart disease) should have a cardiac catheterization recorded before treatment begins.	PH centres who do not meet this standard should review the cases who have not undergone cardiac catheterization before treatment and put in place a strategy to rectify this.	We have reviewed the cases who have been documented not to have undergone a cardiac catheter and all had, but in most cases these were done externally and therefore the documentation in the database was incorrect. The action plan is to review standards quarterly and to identify discrepancies closer to the time of entry.
35	90 per cent of patients who undergo a pulmonary endarterectomy should wait less than four months from their diagnosis of chronic thromboembolic pulmonary hypertension.	NHS England and PH centres need to address the delay in undertaking pulmonary endarterectomy. This requires a joint effort since the patient pathway is complex.	See Royal Papworth response